

1. Describe a time you led a team through a high-pressure delivery.

STAR

S: A client wanted a major feature in 10 days, and the timeline was extremely tight.

T: I had to plan, guide the team, and ensure on-time delivery.

A: I broke work into small tasks, assigned clear owners, removed blockers daily, and handled all client communication myself so team stayed focused.

R: We delivered on time, with zero production bugs, and client appreciated the teamwork.

2. Tell me about a time you created long-term technical direction for a project.

STAR

S: Our project had no long-term architecture plan and code was becoming messy.

T: I had to define a clean technical roadmap.

A: I created architecture guidelines, defined coding standards, improved CI/CD, and planned migration from legacy modules.

R: Team productivity improved and rework reduced significantly.

3. Describe a situation where you influenced senior stakeholders without authority.

STAR

S: Business team wanted to skip load testing to save time.

T: I knew this could break production.

A: I presented simple data, past incidents, and a low-cost plan for quick load testing.

R: They agreed, we did the testing, and found a major memory issue before release.

4. Tell me about a time you handled a critical production incident as the lead.

STAR

S: One morning, a core service stopped processing payments.

T: I had to coordinate the whole recovery.

A: I set up a war room, assigned tasks, managed communication, and personally handled root cause analysis.

R: Service was restored in 30 minutes and RCA helped prevent that issue forever.

5. Describe a time you lifted the performance of a low-performing team member.

STAR

S: One developer was missing deadlines and making repeated mistakes.

T: I needed to improve his confidence and performance.

A: I did 1:1 discussions, understood his gaps, created a simple learning plan, paired with him for important tasks.

R: His delivery became consistent and he later became one of the most reliable team members.

6. Tell me about a time you had to say NO to an unrealistic request.

STAR

S: Client asked for a feature in 2 days, which realistically needed 1 week.

T: I had to protect the team without damaging the relationship.

A: I explained the effort clearly, showed impact on quality and risk, and proposed a smaller Phase-1 instead.

R: Client agreed to phased delivery and appreciated the transparency.

7. Describe a time you handled conflict between two senior developers.

STAR

S: Two seniors disagreed strongly on design and tension grew in the team.

T: I had to resolve the conflict quickly.

A: I arranged a meeting, let both explain calmly, focused them on common goals, and merged the best parts of both designs.

R: They accepted the solution and team collaboration improved.

8. Tell me about a time you made a risky technical decision.

STAR

S: We had to choose between patching a legacy module or rewriting it.

T: Rewrite was risky and time-consuming.

A: I analysed code, effort, business impact, and proposed a controlled partial rewrite.

R: Rewrite removed recurring bugs, and new module became stable and future-proof.

9. Describe a time you improved cross-team collaboration.

STAR

S: Our backend, frontend, and QA teams worked in silos, causing delays.

T: I had to streamline collaboration.

A: I set up joint planning meetings, created shared documentation, and established clear ownership.

R: Miscommunication reduced and delivery speed improved.

10. Tell me about a time you built a culture of accountability and trust.

STAR

S: Team hesitated to take ownership; everyone blamed others for issues.

T: I wanted to build ownership culture.

A: I encouraged open conversations, celebrated small wins, and made people responsible for decisions instead of tasks.

R: Team became more confident and started taking initiative without fear.